The Alignment Clinic
ORTHOPEDIC SPINE SURGERY

The Alignment Clinic of Spine Surgery & Orthopedics
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Clinical Letter

Prepared from the clinical visit note for care coordination and records.

Patient: LetterSmoke Alpha
Date of birth: 1980-05-15
Date of service: 2026-11-07
Physician: Elvis Francois, MD

REASON FOR EVALUATION

Left leg pain with radicular symptoms following motor vehicle collision.

HISTORY OF PRESENT ILLNESS

45-year-old patient involved in a motor vehicle collision approximately two months prior, with onset of left lower extremity radicular pain after the accident. Pain radiates down the left leg. No additional systemic symptoms documented.

RELEVANT HISTORY

Motor vehicle accident two months prior. No other past medical, surgical, or medication history documented in the note.

DIAGNOSTIC STUDIES

Plan to obtain lumbar spine MRI with and without contrast to evaluate for disc herniation, nerve root compression, or other traumatic pathology. No imaging results documented in the visit note.

EXAMINATION

Positive straight leg raise test on the left. No other objective findings documented (motor strength, sensation, reflexes, gait, back inspection not recorded).

ASSESSMENT

1. Lumbosacral radiculopathy, left-sided consistent with clinical left L5/S1 radicular irritation following motor vehicle collision

DISCUSSION AND PLAN

1) Obtain lumbar spine MRI with and without contrast as indicated. 2) Initiate outpatient physical therapy focusing on lumbar stabilization, core strengthening, and graded activity as tolerated. 3) Recommend analgesia as needed (NSAIDs and/or short course acetaminophen); consider muscle relaxant for spasms after reviewing allergies/contraindications. 4) Advise activity modification and work restrictions as appropriate pending imaging and therapy progress. 5) If progressive neurological deficits, severe unremitting pain, or bowel/bladder dysfunction develop, arrange urgent neurosurgical/orthopedic spine evaluation. 6) Follow up after MRI results and after 4–6 weeks of physical therapy or sooner if symptoms worsen.

Elvis Francois, MD